

Must-Have Network Monitoring Tools for Systems Administrators

The trick in managing networks is to anticipate glitches and problems, and nip them in the bud before they can do much harm. To manage and monitor networks manually is tedious and time consuming, besides being quite impossible when there are a large number of nodes; hence the need for monitoring tools. This article gives you a sampling of the most indispensable monitoring tools.



Consider today's computer networks, which are large complex systems, in which many components of various vendors are integrated in order to pass on information. These networks range from small campuses to large geographical regions and worldwide networks. The main purpose of having these networks is to share information among computers. Networks have various applications like email, online transaction processing, remote connectivity, downloading and various social media activities. Organisations that have installed these network applications require that these applications run without any hiccups. For this, network managers have to monitor the network in order to facilitate information flow and to check the status of all network equipment.

Network monitoring is regarded as difficult and demanding, yet a vital part of any network or systems administrator's job. Network monitoring enables operators to fully understand the current behaviour of the network. So, accurate and efficient monitoring is important to ensure that the network operates according to the defined manner and network administrators find it easier to troubleshoot any sort

of error in the network. Network monitoring is defined as the process of capturing network traffic and inspecting it closely to determine what is happening on the network.

Organisations require their network to be up and functioning 24x7 in order to generate revenue, for which they need the right set of tools to monitor and manage the network. Some tools are open source while some are proprietary and hence quite expensive. Organisations have heterogeneous environments comprising multiple network hardware and software from different vendors running under the same roof, for which the network monitoring solution needs to be flexible enough to adapt to changing environments and should support various kinds of hardware and software.

In order to provide organisations dynamic and flexible solutions for network monitoring, the preferred methodology, nowadays, is to make use of open source network monitoring tools. But finding the most suitable tool for network monitoring that fits the precise needs of a particular organisation is quite a challenging task as there are numerous options available.

The various open source tools currently available cover almost all requirements for monitoring networks. These